nothing personal in his criticism. ‘I was doing my job and you were doing yours,’ he said. I met Sodhi for the second and last time in New York on 1 August 1982, outside Richmond Hill Gurudwara in New York, the details of which are given in Chapter 5.

The fact that the R&AW had no interest in Sikh activities or in Sodhi’s quixotic pro-Khalistan agenda in Canada till the end of my tenure in September 1979 would be evident from a letter I received in July-August 1979 from my joint director. In it he informed me that the Department was not interested in the ‘gurudwara politics’ of Canada and I should not waste my time reporting on it. Incidentally, on my return to headquarters, when Suntook asked me in the middle of 1981 to brief the R&AW officers of and above the rank of deputy director on Khalistan, I specifically asked that same joint director as to what had led to the Department’s sudden interest in pro-Khalistan activities. His reply was that things had changed considerably in the meanwhile. However, he did not elaborate what brought about the change within the one and a half years’ time since my return from Canada.

How did things start changing in Canada after Indira Gandhi’s return to power as prime minister in January 1980; how the R&AW, which was not interested in ‘gurudwara politics’ till the end of 1979 suddenly made a 180-degree turnaround under the new government; and how the land which gave birth to the Ghadar movement started hosting pro-Khalistan activities, are dealt with in the subsequent chapters.